



El Monte RV & Road Bear RV Burning Man 2026 – RV Rental Guide

DON'T FORGET YOUR 2026 BURNING MAN TICKETS!

We're thrilled to be part of your journey to Black Rock City! Whether you're a first-timer or a seasoned Burner, this guide is here to help you make the most of your RV experience in the desert.

To keep things running smoothly, it's important to stay on top of your water, propane, and fuel levels, and to arrange service for your holding tanks as needed. Since every RV is a little different, we recommend getting familiar with your vehicle's specific tank capacities before you hit the road.

Let's dive in and make sure you're fully prepared for an unforgettable adventure!

Power Management

Important: Unless you are connected to external power, start your vehicle's engine at least 3 times per day and run for one hour each time, especially before going to sleep, to charge your coach batteries. Alternatively, you can run the generator for 8 hours.

The coach battery switch **MUST** always be 'ON' or the batteries do not get charged.

Your generator uses the engine's gasoline and will automatically shut off at a ¼ tank. You will have approximately 25-40 hours of generator usage as it consumes approximately one gallon of gasoline per hour. The generator runs your A/C, microwave, and electrical outlets. Only run one A/C unit at a time to avoid tripping the generator breaker. Burning Man recommends using generators sparingly out of consideration for your neighbors. After 8 hours of running please check oil level and top off if needed.

Set your A/C thermostat to 79 degrees and close all the windows, roof vents and blinds, curtains and shades. Limit the opening and closing of the entry door. The inside of the vehicle will only cool to a maximum of 20 degrees below the outside temperature. If you have the A/C set too low, it will 'freeze' and you will be without A/C for some time.

Your refrigerator may run on propane or 12V. The refrigerator running on propane should be set to PROPANE. Limit the opening and closing of the refrigerator doors. Take along a cooler/ice chest for your drinks and water. For a 12-volt refrigerator it is critical to maintain the house batteries charge more often by running the generator or engine if you are not connected to external power.

Important! If you are hooked up to external power: You may be held fully responsible for damage to the rental vehicle caused by improper or excessive external electrical connections and repair services will not be available for any resulting damage. Make sure that all appliances and the generator are off before you connect to external power.





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Awning and Leveling System

Awning Use:

If your RV is equipped with an awning, our team will walk you through how to use it. Keep in mind you have to pay \$50 for the Awning Usage on any El Monte Booking (unless you pre-purchased one of our packages that include the Awning Usage). Please note that high winds are common in Black Rock City, and awnings are especially vulnerable. To avoid damage - or worse, total destruction - always retract the awning when not in use. We'd hate to charge you for repairs!

Leveling System:

For RVs with a leveling system, please use it with care. Operation is at your own risk, and any damage or malfunction is the renter's responsibility. Always level on solid, near-level ground using the auto-leveling feature only - never lift the wheels off the ground!

If rain or flooding softens the Playa, retract the jacks immediately to prevent them from sinking and getting stuck. Recovery costs for a stuck vehicle are also the renter's responsibility.

Water Management

Freshwater Use:

Your RV comes with a full freshwater tank at time of pick up. If you need to refill during the event, look out for potable water trucks roaming the playa (Vendor: Meco Reno). Use water sparingly — every drop counts! When washing dishes, use a spray bottle and towel or rag to wipe off food waste (dispose of it in the trash, not the sink drain), then rinse and sanitize using a small container of water. Keep showers short and consider using baby wipes to freshen up between them. Always turn off the water pump when not in use and never leave the bathroom until the toilet has fully stopped running—this can prevent a complete water loss. Use portable bathroom facilities provided by Burning Man as often as possible

Black & Grey Water:

Your waste tanks will be empty at pickup, and our team will show you how to use the dumping hose and valves. There are no RV dump stations in Black Rock City, and dumping on the playa is strictly prohibited. Violators will be cited by BLM. You are responsible for preventing and addressing any leaks.

If you need pumping services, look for trucks marked "RV servicing." Be aware that many trucks are for infrastructure only, so check the signage. The only vendor authorized to accept cash for pumping is United Site Services. Note: these services do not include potable water refills.

Always use one-ply toilet paper to avoid clogs.

Access for Service Trucks:

Make sure your RV is accessible—service hoses can't reach beyond 30 feet. If they can't get to you, they can't help you!

Leave No Trace

Leave no trace/Spills – Please read this:

<https://survival.burningman.org/leave-no-trace/leave-no-trace-tips/>

<https://survival.burningman.org/leave-no-trace/leaky-things-spills-the-most-common-lnt-issues/>





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Support & Resources

Burning Man is a closed event, which means our team cannot provide on-site service within Black Rock City. However, we're still here to support you!

For quick help, refer to the phone number on your key tag to reach our On Road Care Team. Please note that due to the remote location and limited services, support is limited to operational guidance only.

If you need in-person assistance, our On Road Care Team can schedule an appointment at our Reno office, available both before and during the event, for El Monte and Road Bear RV guests:

130 Woodland Ave, Reno, NV 89523

To make your trip even smoother, be sure to download our **Guest Guide** and **walkthrough video** ahead of time. The guide includes a troubleshooting section, and the video is a great refresher if you need a reminder on how things work.

You can find everything here:

[El Monte RV Guides](#)

[Road Bear RV Guides](#)

Terms and Conditions Reminder

Please be aware of the following important terms from your rental agreement:

Section 6. Prohibited Use of the Rental Vehicle

Renter may not:

(e) Drive the Rental Vehicle during weather conditions, and/or on road conditions that Renter and/or Authorized Drivers reasonably understand to be hazardous.

(p) Drive on unpaved roads, trails, and the like, commonly called "logging" roads or any surface subjecting Rental Vehicle to damage or road hazard.

As a result, **all repairs are the Guest's responsibility.**

Due to the extreme desert environment at Burning Man, no credits will be issued for equipment failure or loss of use.

Also, please avoid placing any decorations—such as stickers or tape—on the outside of the RV unless they are easily removable (like painter's tape). Additional cleaning or repainting fees will apply if removal is required.

Burning Man Surcharge

Please note that a \$1,000 non-refundable surcharge applies to any booking travelling to the Burning Man grounds. This fee may have already been included in your booking; however, if it has not been applied, we reserve the right to add it should we identify that your booking includes travel to Burning Man.





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Cleaning and Waste Disposal

Your RV must be returned in the same clean condition as it was delivered—both inside and out. This includes the awning, outer storage compartments, undercarriage, generator, and more. If the vehicle is not returned in this condition, a substantial cleaning fee will apply.

Important:

The primary concern is **Playa dust**, not typical road dirt or bugs. Playa dust is extremely fine and pervasive, it behaves differently than regular dirt. Please do not use standard cleaning products or water inside the RV, as this will only smear the dust and create mud. Instead, we recommend using a vinegar wash.

If the vehicle is not returned in the exact same clean condition inside and outside as it was at pick up, a minimum cleaning fee of \$500 will apply. Vehicles returned in excessively dirty conditions will incur significantly higher charges. If the vehicle is returned completely uncleaned, a minimum fee of \$2,000 will be charged — unless a \$1,500 cleaning fee was prepaid. NO EXCEPTIONS — NO DISCUSSIONS.

Tips from Fellow Burning Man Travelers:

- Cover everything inside the RV with sheets.
- Use thick brown paper (available at Home Depot) to cover the floor, secured with **BLUE painter's tape** (do not use any other kind of tape!).
- Keep windows and roof vents closed at all times. Only open the entry door when entering or exiting to prevent dust from coating the interior.
- Cover window screens—Playa dust is nearly impossible to remove from them.
- Never open or use the awning. It can be damaged by sudden winds and is difficult to clean. Wrap the ends with shrink-wrap to keep dust out.
- Keep all exterior compartment doors closed.
- Do **not** run the generator or engine during a dust storm. Dust can clog the air filter and damage the engine or generator.

Optional Prepaid Cleaning

You may prepay a **\$1,500 cleaning fee** to cover the cost of detailed cleaning to remove Playa dust from the interior, engine, generator, A/C, and more.

Please note: **This fee does not include trash removal.**

Trash Disposal

We strongly recommend disposing of your trash during your return trip. Many communities along the route from Black Rock City offer 24-hour recycling and trash disposal services. You can find a list of these locations here:

<https://burningman.org/event/preparation/leaving-no-trace/leave-nevada-beautiful/>

⚠ Do not bring your trash to the return branch — substantial disposal fees will apply.





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Leave No Trace

Burning Man's core principle is simple: **Leave no trace.**

- Pack it in, pack it out.
- Clean as you go.
- Bring large trash bags and consider using separate bags for recyclables.
- Do not leave anything behind at Black Rock City.

Fuel & Propane Refueling

- **Gasoline:** Our refueling fee is **\$10.00 per gallon**. Please fill up **close to the return location** (not 15 miles away) and double-check the gas gauge before leaving the station.
- **Propane:** Must also be refilled before return. Our propane refueling fee is **\$6.50 per gallon**.

Items left behind

We assume no responsibility for any personal items left behind in the RV. Any such items will be considered abandoned and will be disposed of immediately without further notice.

Vehicle Return

Vehicle returns must take place within the 30-minute time slot selected during your Self Check-in. Late returns will be charged the difference in price for the new drop-off time slot as well as an **additional \$50/hour** charge. Unauthorized rental extensions will be billed at **double the nightly rental rate**.

⚠ Important: Do not leave the vehicle outside our rental lot.

Vehicles left in unsafe or unauthorized areas are subject to **towing and fines**, for which the renter is fully responsible. Any damage caused by **vandalism or break-ins** will also be the **renter's responsibility**.

Shuttle Service (Road Bear RV only)

Our complimentary shuttle departs at **11:00 AM**, but is only available under the following conditions:

- Shuttle product has been added to your booking at least 30 days prior to pickup
- Shuttle service must be arranged at the time of vehicle pickup.
- You must arrive at the drop-off branch **no later than 10:00 AM** to be eligible.

Our complimentary shuttle service is only available from the following locations:

- Los Angeles – Agoura Hills
- San Francisco – San Leandro
- Las Vegas

Luggage Policy:

Shuttle luggage limits follow standard airline regulations:

- 1 suitcase (up to 50 lbs / 23 kg)
- 1 carry-on item per person

Please note: **Excess luggage is the guest's responsibility.**





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Conclusion

You're now fully equipped with the knowledge and tips to make your Burning Man adventure smooth, safe, and unforgettable. From power management and water conservation to cleaning hacks and return policies, we hope this guide helps you feel confident and prepared every step of the way.

Thank you for choosing us to be part of your journey to Black Rock City. We're honored to support your experience and can't wait to welcome you back next year.

Have an amazing time at Burning Man 2026—and we hope to see you again in 2027!

Safe travels and happy adventuring,
The El Monte RV & Road Bear RV Teams

